strengthen their arguments and propaganda could influence the sensibilities of many religious-minded people. Many might have already succumbed to their trap.

Sadly, little seemed to have been done by the government to control and counter this silent but lethal onslaught. Rather there was a complete disregard for the dire repercussions of this media war that had been enabling the militants and terrorists to gain a stronger foothold and make deeper inroads in society.

CLAIMING RESPONSIBILITY

TTP followed a mechanism and strategy to accept or deny the responsibility of a terrorist act committed by it. The terrorist attacks on police, intelligence, army and law enforcement agencies were followed by the statements of TTP spokesperson who claimed the responsibility. However, it did not claim responsibility of the attacks on non-government targets such as shrines, markets and educational institutions in order to avoid public animosity.

During the emergence of 'modern terrorism', approximately 200 years ago, terrorists endorsed a doctrine of terrorism as 'propaganda of the deed'. For these terrorists, claiming responsibility for their violence and the havoc it created was the most significant difference between their acts and those of criminal organisations. But during the last 50 years there had been a change in the approach of terrorist organisations. The number of claims decreased significantly. 'From the late 1990s until 2004, the percentage of claimed acts of terror plummeted to 14.5 per cent, of which only half could be confirmed as valid claims of responsibility' (Wright, 2009). Therefore, claiming and disclaiming responsibility is a universally employed tactic of terrorists.

The TTP had been pursuing a carefully crafted policy of claiming and disclaiming the responsibility. Its spokesperson who owned the responsibility would contact a few selected journalists who knew him (sometimes by email). He would not mind telling his name but kept his location undisclosed. Many people doubted the authenticity of the so-called spokesperson and his claims. However, one could not resist believing the claim when it was initiated by reputable news agencies and published in prestigious and credible dailies like *DAWN*, *Daily Jang*, *The News International* and *The Nation*.